

Continental drift

The Earth once had just one huge landmass, which Alfred named Pangaea (meaning “all lands”).

Over time, Pangaea split up into pieces.

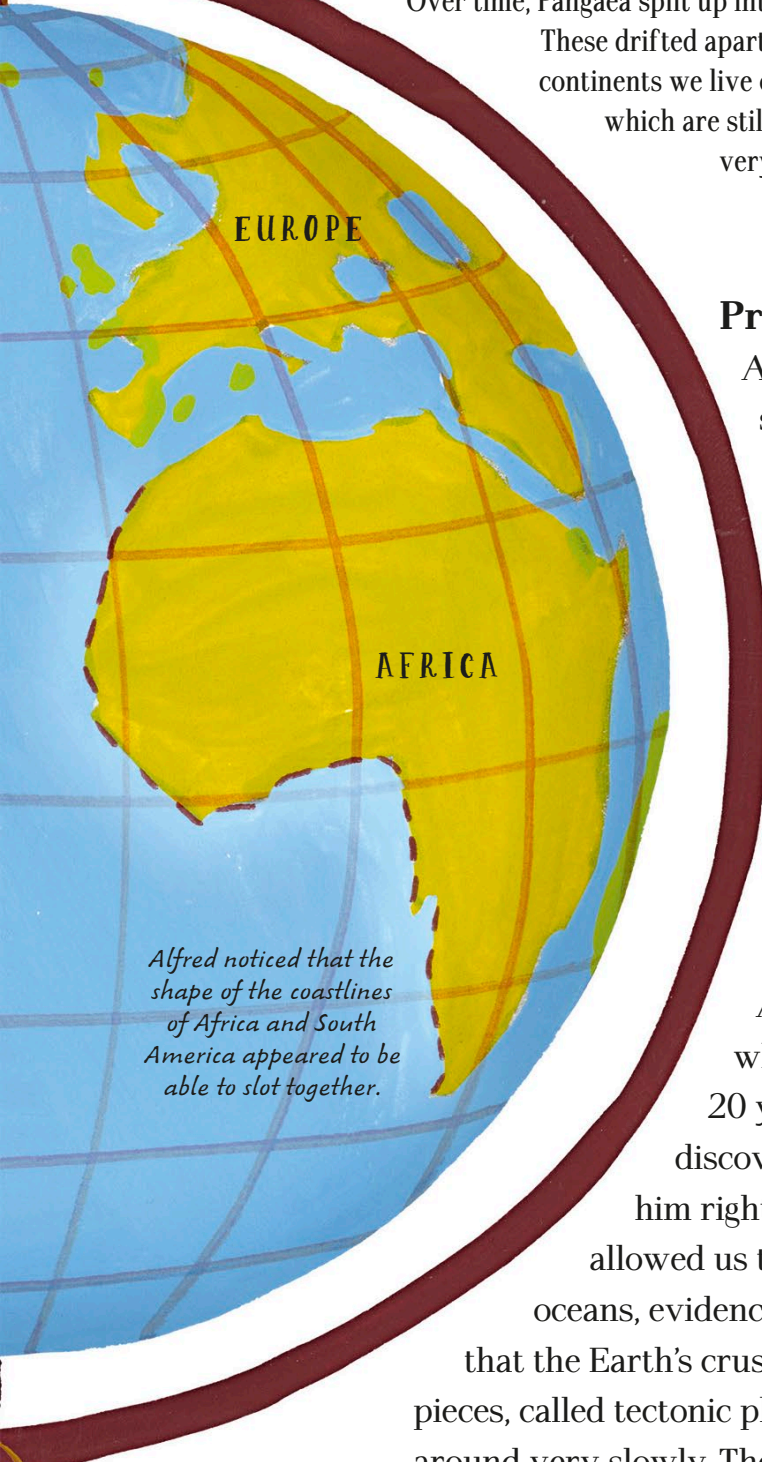
These drifted apart into the continents we live on today, which are still moving very slowly!



270 million years ago



200 million years ago



EUROPE

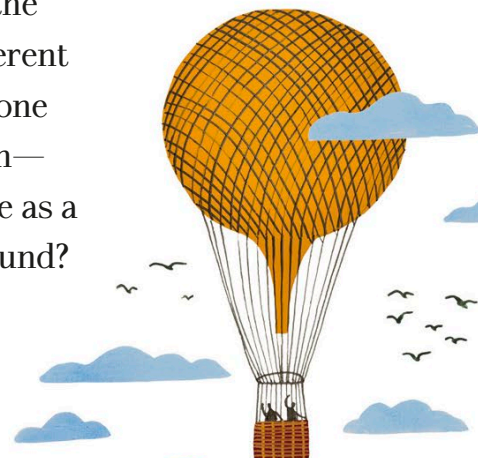
AFRICA

Alfred noticed that the shape of the coastlines of Africa and South America appeared to be able to slot together.

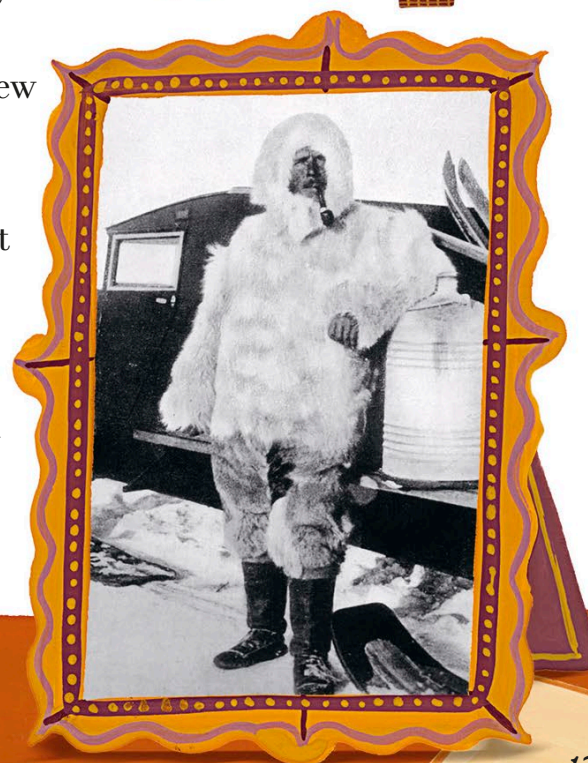
Proof of Pangaea

Alfred collected masses of evidence to support his idea. He used fossils and rocks to show that parts of the world had completely different climates than they do today because the continents used to be in different places. However, there was one thing Alfred couldn't explain—*how could something as large as a continent possibly move around?*

Alfred lived for adventure and loved hiking, sailing, and exploring. He even broke a world record by floating in a hot-air balloon for 52 hours!



Sadly, few people took Alfred's idea seriously while he was alive. But 20 years after he died, new discoveries began to prove him right. As technology allowed us to explore the deepest oceans, evidence was found showing that the Earth's crust is split into huge pieces, called tectonic plates, that move around very slowly. These movements carry continents with them—just as Alfred said!



Alfred died while hiking across Greenland on a heroic rescue mission.

